Assessing traceability RegTech applications for the honey bee and cherry industries and related supply chains

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET

Research team

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1. Invitation

You are invited to participate in an online survey examining factors influencing the implementation of digital compliance software (RegTech) and its core role in supporting agricultural compliance and strengthening traceability systems in the Australian honey bee and cherry industries.

2. What is the purpose of this study?

This major national study investigates the factors that influence the implementation of digital compliance software (RegTech), how existing traceability technology use may support RegTech applications, and how RegTech in turn strengthens existing traceability systems. The findings of the study will provide recommendations to the Australian Government including a roadmap to support the implementation of digital

compliance technologies in the honeybee and cherry sectors, that may be generalised to broader agricultural industries in Australia.

3. How is the study being funded?

This study is funded by the *National Agriculture Traceability Regulatory Technology Research and Insights Grant Program*. Reporting is administered by the *National Traceability Enhancement Section* of the *Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry (DAFF)*. Funding for a PhD candidate was 50% provided by DAFF and the remainder by the University of Tasmania.

4. Why have I been invited to participate?

You have been invited to participate due to your experience and knowledge in either honeybee or cherry related businesses and therefore will have important views on the value and impact of digitalising biosecurity compliance or traceability activities. Participation is entirely voluntary, and choosing not to take part will have no consequences. Please note it is a requirement that you are 18 years of age or older to participate in the survey.

5. What will I be asked to do?

If you choose to participate, you will be asked to complete an anonymous online survey, which will take approximately 15 minutes to compete. The survey uses mainly multiple-choice questions with some open-ended questions if you wish to provide additional information. With the exception of a question related to which industry you work within, all other questions can be skipped if preferred.

The survey includes questions about current traceability practices and technologies, use of digital technologies and software, incentives and barriers for RegTech implementation, potential costs and benefits across the supply chain, and future intentions regarding digital compliance technologies.

6. Are there any possible benefits from participation in this study?

Benefits from participating in the study may include reflecting on your current compliance and digital practices. Importantly, your views will assist in providing an industry perspective that may help government, industry organisations, researchers, and software developers in improving digital compliance and traceability systems within Australian agriculture.

If you wish to benchmark your responses against responses from your industry, you may opt to receive a summary of the findings that will be available at the conclusion of the study by contacting Linda Jinying Li, the student investigator via email at Jinying.Li@utas.edu.au. This process ensures that your information from the survey remains anonymous.

7. Are there any possible risks from participation in this study?

There are no specific risks anticipated with your participation in this study.

8. What if I change my mind during or after the study?

Participation is voluntary. You may stop completing the survey at any time before submitting your responses by simply closing your browser. As the survey is anonymous, once you have submitted your responses it will not be possible to withdraw your data, as the researchers will be unable to identify which responses belong to you.

9. What will happen to the data when this study is over?

Survey responses will be stored securely on University of Tasmania systems. This storage solution complies with institutional data management protocols and ensures that all research data remain confidential and accessible only to authorised members of the research team.

The data will be retained for five years from the date of publication of the DAFF-funded project, in accordance with the Australian Code for the Responsible Conduct of Research. After this period, the data will be securely destroyed.

10. How will the results of the study be published?

All results will be reported in summary or aggregated form in project reports to DAFF scholarly publications, conference presentations, and the associated PhD thesis. No individual participant or business will be identified in any publication or presentation. You may request a summary of study findings by sending an email to Jinying.Li@utas.edu.au.

11. What if I have questions about this study?

If you have any queries, concerns or issues with this study, please feel free to contact either of the following project team members.

Prof Stephen Cahoon Stephen.Cahoon@utas.edu.au (03) 6226 2306	Chief investigator
Linda Jinying Li Jinying.Li@utas.edu.au	PhD candidate

This study has been approved by the University of Tasmania Human Research Ethics Committee (HREC). If you have concerns or complaints about the conduct of this study, you can contact the Executive Officer of the HREC on (03) 6226 6254 or email human.ethics@utas.edu.au. The Executive Officer is the person nominated to receive complaints from research participants. You will need to quote Project ID H40885.

12. How can I agree to be involved?

If you decide to participate, please click on the survey link below or in the invitation email. Before accessing the survey questions, you will be asked to indicate your consent to participate. To participate in the survey, please click on the following link or scan the QR code:
https://utas.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_3HMZ0k7l8zP2eWy



Thank you for your valuable time and contribution to this research.